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A Wrong Man in Workers' Paradise -

Rabindranath Tagore

A Note On The author :

Rabindranath Tagore (1861–1941) was a renowned Indian poet, writer, philosopher, and artist. He was the first non-European to receive the Nobel Prize in Literature in 1913 for his collection of poems, *Gitanjali*. Tagore played a key role in reshaping Bengali literature and music and was a prominent figure in the Indian independence movement, advocating for cultural revival and self-reliance.

He composed the national anthems of India (*Jana Gana Mana*) and Bangladesh (*Amar Sonar Bangla*), showcasing his deep influence on both nations. His literary works include novels (*Gora*, *Ghare-Baire*), short stories, plays, and essays, reflecting themes of humanism, nature, and nationalism. He also founded Visva-Bharati University, emphasizing the importance of holistic education.

A Wrong Man in Workers' Paradise Summary :

This is a very interesting and entertaining short story written by the Nobel Prize winner Rabindranath Tagore. Along with amusing with its paradoxical statements, it raises some important questions about work, leisure, utility and emotions etc.

The phrase “the Moving Finger” is taken from Omar Khayyam’s ‘*Rubiyat*’ where the moving finger means ‘time’ or ‘fate’, and man doesn’t have the freedom to change anything that time has decided for him. However, in this story, the mistake of the moving finger is corrected by the elders of Paradise.

Due to a mistake of the Moving Finger, an artist, who had wasted his time only painting all the while, lands up in Workers’ Paradise. He doesn’t know how to pass the time there because all the others are busy moving here and there doing something or the other all the time.

Once a girl looks at him, and seeing that he doesn’t have work, offers to give him some of her work. But the artist refuses and instead asks her pitcher to draw pictures on it. The girl doesn’t understand why he wants to draw pictures, but after some persuasion, gives her pitcher to him. After he draws some pictures, she asks him the meaning of those pictures, but the artist says that a picture may have no meaning or purpose. The girl is puzzled by his answer and is gradually so mesmerized by his work that, instead of running to do her work, she becomes thoughtful and slow at her work.

The next time when he asks for her ribbons to colour them, she gives them readily and spends more time on trying the colourful ribbons.

Many people get similarly influenced by the artist and his work. Work in the Workers' Paradise starts suffering. The elders frown at this and order the artist out of Paradise. When the artist is going, the girl too follows him, puzzling all the elders in Paradise. For them, till then only work had been important, and fascination with art, friendship or love had no meaning at all.

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Long Answer Questions:

1. Describe the life of the people in Workers' Paradise and compare it with the wrong man's lifestyle.

Ans: The people in Workers' Paradise were always busy and believed that every moment should be spent productively. They complained about not having a moment to spare. In contrast, the wrong man lived a carefree life, focusing on artistic pursuits that didn't serve any useful purpose. He created sculptures and paintings, activities that were considered a waste of time in the Workers' Paradise.

2. How does the story illustrate the conflict between utility and art?

Ans: In Workers' Paradise, everything revolves around useful work, and art is seen as unnecessary. The wrong man, who only engages in artistic activities, disrupts this order. However, his art begins to influence the people, showing them the value of beauty and creativity beyond utility. The story suggests that art has its own importance and can bring a new perspective to a life solely focused on utility.

3. Explain the significance of the girl's transformation in the story.

Ans: Initially, the girl of Workers' Paradise is completely absorbed in her work, seeing no value in art. But after the wrong man paints her pitcher, she becomes curious and fascinated by something that has no practical use. Her change in attitude reflects the story's message that art can enrich life by adding beauty and meaning, even if it serves no immediate purpose.

4. What is the message of 'A Wrong Man in Workers' Paradise'?

Ans: The story conveys that while practical work is important, there is also a place for creativity, art, and beauty in life. It challenges the idea that everything must serve a practical purpose and suggests that activities which seem meaningless at first can bring joy and transformation.

5. Discuss how Rabindranath Tagore uses symbolism in the story to convey deeper meanings.

Ans: Tagore uses the Workers' Paradise as a symbol of a utilitarian society, where time is strictly measured by productivity. The wrong man symbolizes the artist, whose work doesn't fit into the narrow definitions of utility. The girl's pitcher, which is transformed by art, represents how creativity can alter one's perspective. Through these symbols, Tagore explores the tension between art and practicality, suggesting that life is incomplete without beauty and imagination.

Frequently Asked Questions:

1.The elders of the Workers' Paradise became anxious, why?

Ans: The elders became anxious because the wrong man, with his artistic activities, started distracting the people from their usual hard work. People, especially the girl, began spending time on art instead of finishing their useful tasks, which worried the elders about the order and productivity of Workers' Paradise.

2.Why did the idler ask the girl of the silent torrent for one of her pitchers?

Ans: The idler (the wrong man) asked the girl for one of her pitchers so that he could paint on it. He was not interested in using the pitcher for practical purposes but wanted to create art on it.

3.How were the ribbons made by the idler responsible for the girl's work remaining unfinished?

Ans: The idler made colorful ribbons for the girl, and the girl spent a lot of time tying and arranging these ribbons in her hair. This took up her time, causing her to leave some of her regular work unfinished.

4.Why didn't the man fit in with the scheme of things in Workers' Paradise?

Ans: The man didn't fit in because Workers' Paradise was a place where everyone was always busy with practical and useful work. The man, however, spent his time on art and creativity, which the people there considered a waste of time.

5.What changes took place in the girl after the wrong man gave her the painted pitcher?

Ans: After receiving the painted pitcher, the girl became curious about the beauty of the art. She started spending time looking at it and began to appreciate art, something she had never cared about before. This made her less focused on her regular work.

6.What does "hurrying feet" suggest? Why did they become less hurried?

Ans: "Hurrying feet" suggests that the girl was always rushing and busy with work. Her feet became "less hurried" after she received the painted pitcher because she started taking time to enjoy and appreciate the beauty of the painting, slowing down from her usual fast pace.

7.How did the painter waste his time on the earth?

Ans: The painter (the wrong man) wasted his time on Earth by doing things that were not useful, like painting and making sculptures. People around him thought these activities had no practical value.

8. Describe how the girl examined the painted pitcher at home. What was the impact on her?

Ans: At home, the girl secretly examined the painted pitcher, turning it around and looking at it from all angles. She was puzzled at first, as it had no practical use, but she couldn't stop admiring its beauty. This was the first time she had encountered something purely for beauty's sake, which changed her perspective on life.

9. What changes were noticed in the movement and attitude of the girl of the silent torrent after the man gave her the painted pitcher?

Ans: After receiving the painted pitcher, the girl's movements became slower, and her attitude changed. She started paying more attention to beauty and art, and her busy, rushed attitude became more relaxed as she spent time enjoying the painted pitcher.

10. What do you understand from the statement "some boys seldom ply their books and yet pass their tests"?

Ans: This statement means that some boys don't study hard or spend much time on their books, but they still manage to pass their tests. It suggests that not everyone who succeeds does so through hard work; sometimes, they are just lucky or smart enough to pass without much effort.

The Elixir of Life - Sir C.V. Raman

A Note On The Author :

Sir C.V. Raman (1888-1970) had a keen interest in Science even from his boyhood days. For his famous discovery called "The Raman Effect", he was awarded the Nobel Prize for Physics in 1930. King George Knighted him for his contributions to Physics. The Government of India awarded him the Bharat Ratna and the Soviet Union honoured him with the International Lenin Prize in 1957

The Elixir of Life Summary :

1. Dr. C.V. Raman is a great scientist. His explorations are mainly in the field of optics. "Raman Spectra" is one of the greatest explorations in science field invented by him. Water has more importance for us. Unless the water, it is impossible to live in a proper way. Water is the elixir of life.
2. Dr. C. V. Raman gave an important task on the water that water gives beauty to nature such that when the sun shines or sets, that rays in the pond or river give beautiful, tremendous vision to us. Mainly, water adds beauty to the countryside. In South India, all tanks are filled with rain water with cheering sight.
3. Dr. C.V. Raman also suggested to humankind that the conservation and utilization of water is fundamental for human welfare. The precious fluid known to be water is lost if the water is not controlled.
4. Like this Dr. C.V. Raman gave an elaborate note of the unique power of the elixir of life, called water. When water carries silt or fine soil, water takes the color of the soil with which makes the land fertile. This flow of water makes a beneficial role in the formation of the earth's surface. If we neglect this water, this water can, swept away the silt and finally destroy agriculture.
5. In the absence of plain water, it makes a land a dry and lifeless desert, but the presence of water then it turns the land most fertile.

Long Answer Questions:

1.Explain how water is the true elixir of life.

Ans: Water is described as the true elixir of life because it is fundamental to all living organisms. Plants, animals, and humans rely on water for survival. Water helps plants grow, provides hydration for animals, and shapes the landscape through rivers and lakes. It plays a crucial role in agriculture, which is the backbone of human civilization. Without water, life on Earth would not be possible.

2.Describe the importance of water in shaping the Earth's landscape, as explained by C.V. Raman.

Ans: Sir C.V. Raman explains that water shapes the Earth by carrying silt and depositing it in valleys, forming fertile lands. He mentions the Nile River as an example, where the river's floodwaters created fertile soil in Egypt, allowing civilizations to flourish. Water also creates lakes, rivers, and ponds, which enhance the beauty of the landscape and sustain life. Raman emphasizes that water has played a vital role in both the formation of land and the survival of species throughout history.

3.What are the causes of soil erosion, and how can it be prevented?

Ans: Soil erosion is caused by factors like heavy rainfall, deforestation, and improper farming practices. The removal of vegetation exposes the soil to wind and water, leading to its gradual removal. This process can be prevented by methods such as planting trees (afforestation), constructing bunds or terraces on hillsides to slow down water flow, and practicing contour ploughing to reduce runoff. By implementing these measures, soil can be conserved, ensuring the land remains fertile for agriculture.

4.How does C.V. Raman emphasize the importance of water conservation?

Ans: Raman stresses the need to conserve water because it is a limited resource. He discusses how rainwater is often wasted, flowing into rivers and the sea instead of being used for agriculture and drinking. He suggests harnessing rivers and creating storage systems to save water for future use. He also highlights the role of afforestation in conserving water, as trees help retain moisture in the soil. Water conservation is essential to ensure that we have enough water for agriculture and human needs, especially in countries with seasonal rainfall like India.

5. Discuss the connection between soil erosion and water conservation as described in the chapter.

Ans: Sir C.V. Raman explains that soil erosion and water conservation are closely linked. When soil erosion occurs, the land loses its ability to retain water, making it difficult for plants to grow. This leads to a reduction in agricultural productivity. By preventing soil erosion through afforestation, terracing, and proper farming practices, we can conserve both soil and water. Conserving water helps maintain soil fertility, which in turn supports agriculture and sustains life. Thus, protecting soil from erosion also ensures the effective use of water resources.

Frequently Asked Questions:

1. Mention the advantages of civilized forests.

Ans: Civilized forests, which are systematically planted and maintained, help prevent soil erosion, conserve water, and contribute to the overall beauty of the environment. They also provide resources like wood and help maintain ecological balance by supporting wildlife.

2. How is the precious soil eroded and how can this be prevented?

Ans: Soil erosion happens when heavy rains wash away the top layer of soil, or when wind blows it away. This can be prevented by planting trees (afforestation), building terraces on slopes to slow down water, and practicing contour ploughing. These methods help keep the soil in place and reduce erosion.

3. What does C.V. Raman say about the beauty of the countryside and rain-fed tanks?

Ans: Raman describes water as adding to the beauty of the countryside, making the landscape vibrant with rivers, ponds, and streams. He highlights the rain-fed tanks in South India, which when full, are a cheerful sight. Even though these tanks are shallow, they play a crucial role in agriculture and add beauty to the environment by reflecting sunlight.

4. C.V. Raman says that water is the real elixir of life. Justify with examples.

Ans: Water is essential for all living beings plants, animals, and humans. Raman uses the example of the Nile River to show how water transforms a barren desert into a fertile, green valley. Without water, life would not be possible, as it is needed for agriculture, drinking, and maintaining the ecosystem.

5.The author says, “Egypt, in fact, was made by its river.” What is your inference about that?

Ans: This statement means that the Nile River played a crucial role in the creation of Egypt’s civilization. The fertile soil deposited by the river allowed agriculture to thrive, supporting life and growth in the region. The river’s presence made Egypt one of the most prosperous and advanced civilizations of the ancient world.

6.Water is the basis of all life. Justify.

Ans: Water is fundamental to the survival of all living organisms. Plants need water to grow, and animals and humans require it for drinking and other vital bodily functions. Water also helps regulate temperature, supports agriculture, and forms the habitat for countless species in rivers, lakes, and oceans. Without water, life on Earth would not be possible.

7.What is the dual purpose that the author talks about in the chapter “The Elixir of Life”?

Ans: The dual purpose is the prevention of soil erosion and the conservation of water. By adopting methods to prevent soil erosion, such as planting trees, we also conserve water by keeping it in the soil and preventing it from running off. This helps in agriculture and ensures a sustainable water supply.

8.What according to the author is a "civilized forest"?

Ans: A "civilized forest" is a man-made, systematically planted forest that is maintained to prevent soil erosion and conserve water. Unlike wild, natural forests, these forests are created to serve practical purposes like protecting the environment and providing resources.

9.What is the imaginary elixir of life, and what is the contrast to this with water?

Ans: The imaginary elixir of life is a mythical substance that people believed could grant immortality. In contrast, the real elixir of life, according to C.V. Raman, is water, which is much more valuable because it sustains life and plays a vital role in the survival of all living organisms.

10.What does the author compare the water bodies to?

Ans: The author, C.V. Raman, compares water bodies to the eyes in a human face. Just as eyes reflect the emotions and moods of a person, water bodies reflect the mood of the landscape. They can appear bright and cheerful when the sun shines or dark and gloomy when the sky is overcast. This comparison highlights how water bodies add beauty and life to the environment, just as eyes do to a face.

The Gift of the Magi - o. Henry

A Note On The Author :

O. Henry was the pen name of William Sydney Porter. He was born on September 11, 1862 in Greensboro, North Carolina; and he became famous for his short stories. He started The Rolling Stone, a humorous weekly in 1887 and he was writing for Houston Post. He wrote a story each week for New York World. He has penned more than 600 stories. The first collection of his stories appeared in 1904 in Cabbages and Kings, which was immediately popular. Other collections followed, The Trimmed Lamp (1907).

The Gift of the Magi Summary :

The Gift of the Magi is a story about a poor but devoted couple Jim and Della who sacrificed their best treasures to purchase Christmas gifts for each other.

She had intended to give a surprise present to her husband on the eve of Christmas.

She had saved one dollar and eighty- seven cents after hard bargaining with the grocer, vegetable man, and the butcher.

She had only \$1.87 with which to buy Jim a present.

She wanted to buy something nice for him but she couldn't.

Now there were two possessions of the James Dillingham Young in which both took a mighty pride.

One way Jim's gold watch that had been his father's and his grandfather's.

The other was Della's long, beautiful hair, the hair below her knee. She sold her hair for twenty dollars.

She bought a platinum fob chain, simple and chaste in design for 21 dollars. She hurried home With 87 Cents. With that chain on his watch, Jim might be properly anxious about the time in any company.

Jim came home, "Merry Christmas! Jim. Let's be happy. You don't know what a nice gift I have got for you".T have my hair cut and sold it because I couldn't have lived through Christmas without giving you a present" said Della.

Jim presented her beautiful combs, pure tortoise shell with Jeweled rims.

She hugged them to her bosom. Della presented him with a golden chain for his watch.

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Long Answer Questions:

1. Discuss the theme of love and sacrifice in The Gift of the Magi.

Ans: The theme of love and sacrifice is central to the story. Both Della and Jim demonstrate their deep love for each other through their sacrifices. Della sells her hair, which she values greatly, to buy a gift for Jim. Jim, in turn, sells his watch, a family heirloom, to buy Della the combs she desires. Their actions reflect the idea that true love involves putting the needs and happiness of a loved one above one's own. The story ultimately teaches that the greatest gift one can give is love, even if it comes with personal sacrifice.

2. Analyse how O. Henry uses irony in the story.

Ans: O. Henry masterfully uses situational irony in the story. The ending reveals that both Della and Jim have given up their most valued possessions to buy gifts for each other that they can no longer use. Della's beautiful hair is cut off, making her gift of the platinum chain useless, while Jim's watch, for which he bought the combs, is no longer owned by him. This ironic twist highlights the futility of material gifts when true love and sacrifice are present. It emphasizes that the essence of their love is more valuable than any material possessions.

3. How do Della and Jim exemplify the idea of selflessness?

Ans: Della and Jim exemplify selflessness through their willingness to sacrifice their own happiness for the sake of each other. Della, despite having little money, finds a way to give Jim a meaningful gift, showing her deep affection. She willingly parts with her hair, which represents her beauty and identity, to purchase the chain. Similarly, Jim gives up his watch, a symbol of his heritage and status, to buy combs that will enhance Della's beauty. Their actions demonstrate that their love for each other takes precedence over their own desires and possessions.

4. What does the ending of the story reveal about the nature of true wealth?

Ans: The ending of the story reveals that true wealth lies not in material possessions but in love and sacrifice. Della and Jim's actions show that their love for each other is far more valuable than the gifts they exchanged. Their willingness to give up their most prized possessions illustrates that the depth of their love is what truly enriches their lives. This message suggests that emotional connections and the bonds of love are the most significant forms of wealth one can possess.

5. Discuss the significance of the title The Gift of the Magi.

Ans: The title The Gift of the Magi refers to the Biblical Magi, who brought valuable gifts to the newborn Jesus. In this story, the gifts exchanged by Della and Jim represent the ultimate act of love and sacrifice, similar to the gifts of the Magi. The title signifies that the greatest gifts are not material but come from the heart. It emphasizes that true giving involves selflessness and that the essence of a gift lies in the thought and love behind it, rather than its monetary value.

Frequently Asked Questions:

1. What did Della buy for Jim?

Ans: Della bought a beautiful platinum fob chain for Jim's prized possession, his gold watch. She wanted to buy something special that would complement the watch and show her love for him.

2. What does the writer compare Della's hair to when it fell about her rippling?

Ans: When Della's hair fell about her rippling, the writer compares it to a cascade of brown waters. This comparison highlights the beauty and flowing nature of her long hair, emphasizing its value to her and how it adds to her appearance.

3. How did Della try to fix her hair before Jim got home and why?

Ans: Before Jim got home, Della tried to fix her hair by putting it up as best as she could after selling it. She wanted to appear attractive to Jim and avoid revealing her sacrifice immediately. Della knew that her hair was one of her most beautiful features, and she hoped to mask the change until she could explain it to him.

4. Explain the context "Take your hat off and let's have a sight at the looks of it."

Ans: This line is spoken by Madame Sofronie, the woman who buys Della's hair. It reflects the practical nature of the transaction and Sofronie's business-like attitude. Della is nervous as she sells her hair, but this statement shows Sofronie's experience in the trade of hair goods, emphasizing the value of Della's long hair.

5. Explain the context "Unwrap the package you may see why you had me going a while at first."

Ans: This line comes after Jim gives Della her gift. Jim is teasing her a bit, indicating that there's a surprise inside the package. It highlights the playful nature of their relationship and the joy they share, even when the situation is bittersweet due to their sacrifices.

6.Explain the context “It will grow out again. You won’t mind, will you?”

Ans: Della says this to Jim when she is anxious about how he will react to her short hair after selling it. It reflects her insecurity and desire for reassurance. This line highlights the love they share, as they both recognize that their feelings for each other are more important than their physical appearances or possessions.

7.Explain the context “Will you buy my hair?”

Ans: This line is spoken by Della when she approaches Madame Sofronie to sell her hair. It signifies Della’s desperation and willingness to sacrifice something precious for the sake of love. This moment sets the stage for the story’s central theme of love and sacrifice.

8.What are the comparisons that the author does with the precious possessions of Jim and Della?

Ans: The author compares Jim’s watch, which has been passed down through generations, to a family heirloom symbolizing his heritage and pride. Della’s hair is compared to a cascade of beauty, representing her femininity and identity. Both possessions hold significant emotional value for them and symbolize their love and connection to each other.

9.Describe the gifts of Jim and Della, and how they were apt for each of them.

Ans: Della’s gift of the platinum fob chain is apt for Jim because it complements his cherished watch, signifying her understanding of his values. Jim’s gift of the tortoise shell combs is perfect for Della because they reflect his appreciation of her beauty and the value he places on her long hair. Both gifts show that they know each other deeply and want to enhance each other’s lives, despite the irony of their sacrifices.

10.Give a description of Jim and Della, justifying why they were made for each other.

Ans: Jim and Della are described as young and deeply in love, living a modest life in a small apartment. Della is characterized by her beauty and her long, luxurious hair, while Jim is depicted as a hardworking man who values his watch, a symbol of his family heritage. Their mutual sacrifices illustrate their selflessness and dedication to one another. They are made for each other because their love transcends material possessions; they understand and value each other’s sacrifices, demonstrating that their bond is based on love rather than wealth.

Louis Pasteur, Conqueror of Disease

- E.H. Carter

A Note On The Author :

E.H. Carter was a historian and author known for his works on British and world history. He wrote several history textbooks that were widely used in schools, including A History of Britain. His books were known for their clear and engaging style, making historical events accessible to students.

Louis Pasteur, Conqueror of Disease Summary :

Louis Pasteur was born to a tanner who had worked in Napoleon's army and had been honoured by him. Louis was born in France.

He studied Chemistry and became a Chemistry Professor. His wife was also his assistant during experiments.

Louis devoted his whole life to the study of bacteria which are present everywhere – air, water, soil, bodies of animals and plants. Some of them are harmful and some very useful.

Louis' discoveries helped common people of his country carry on their professions of brewing, breeding silk worms and keeping cows.

When Pasteur was appointed as Head of a College of Science in Lille, a busy manufacturing town, he was happy because now he could help people with problems in their professions. At that time, people did not have a clear understanding of yeast and germs.

Pasteur carried out many experiments to prove that germs were carried in the air and could infect other things that came into contact with them. His experiments with a bend in the long tube of a soup bottle and many bottles of soup opened in different places, proved that air is full of dust particles and germs are carried by this dust.

Pasteur made his process of 'Pasteurization' popular by showing that by heating wine or milk to a temperature of 50 or 60 degrees centigrade, the germ in them was made harmless.

Pasteur founded the branch of science called 'Bacteriology' and studied for 3 years the cause of a disease ruining the silkworm industry. When Pasteur realized that a cow could not have anthrax twice, he thought of injecting very weak old germs to cows or sheep to make them immune from anthrax. He demonstrated that this could be done so by experimenting in public with two groups of sheep, goats, and cows. The ones which were injected with weak germs survived, whereas the other group which hadn't been injected died.

Pasteur showed that inoculation with weak germs worked with rabies too by injecting weak rabies germs into a rabies-affected boy.

Pasteur's work help soldiers in the First World War stay healthy even while fighting in unhealthy places.

Pasteur was honoured by the French Government, and his memory is still honored at the Institute Pasteur in Paris where bacteriology is studied by men of all nations.

Pasteur's 70th birthday was celebrated as a national festival. He died in 1895 at the age of 75.

Pasteur felt that the future belonged to those who shall have done the most for suffering humanity. He told youngsters that they would feel supreme happiness only when they contributed to the progress and welfare of humanity.

Short Answer Questions:

1.What was Louis Pasteur's contribution to science?

Ans: Louis Pasteur contributed to science by developing the germ theory of disease, which established that microorganisms cause infections and diseases.

2.How did Pasteur's discoveries impact the field of medicine?

Ans: Pasteur's discoveries led to the development of vaccines and improved hygiene practices, significantly reducing the incidence of diseases such as rabies and anthrax.

3.“He was not a soldier, but he was a fighter.”

Ans: This metaphor celebrates Pasteur's dedication to science, presenting his research as a heroic struggle against disease.

4.“Pasteur founded the branch of science called ‘bacteriology.’

Ans: This line underlines Pasteur's profound impact on science, marking the beginning of modern bacteriology and the fight against infectious diseases.

5.“His successes saved thousands of lives.”

Ans: This statement honors Pasteur's contributions to medicine, emphasizing his lasting legacy in saving lives and advancing public health.

Long Answer Questions:

1.Explain the experiments Pasteur conducted to develop the germ theory.

Ans: Pasteur conducted several key experiments, including the swan-neck flask experiment. He boiled broth in flasks to sterilize it, then left the flasks open to the air. The unique design of the swan-neck prevented airborne contaminants from entering while allowing air to circulate. Over time, the broth in the straight-necked flasks became cloudy with microbial growth, while the broth in the swan-necked flasks remained clear. This demonstrated that microorganisms in the air were responsible for contamination and spoilage, supporting his germ theory of disease.

2.What was the significance of Pasteur's work on the rabies vaccine?

Ans: Pasteur's work on the rabies vaccine was significant because it was one of the first successful vaccines developed for a viral disease. By using weakened rabies virus samples, he was able to create immunity in animals and, later, in humans. This breakthrough not only saved countless lives but also established a model for vaccine development that would lead to further advancements in immunization against other diseases.

3. Analyse the challenges Pasteur faced in promoting his ideas and the response he received from the scientific community.

Ans: Pasteur faced considerable challenges in promoting his ideas, particularly resistance from the scientific community that adhered to older theories, like the miasma theory. Many scientists were sceptical of his germ theory, and he often had to defend his findings against criticism. Despite these challenges, Pasteur persisted, conducting experiments and publishing results that gradually gained acceptance. His determination and eventual success in proving the existence of germs and their connection to disease ultimately won over many sceptics and transformed the field of microbiology.

4. Describe how Pasteur's personal life influenced his scientific career.

Ans: Pasteur's personal life greatly influenced his scientific career. His early experiences with illness and loss, particularly the death of his daughter from typhoid fever, fuelled his passion for understanding diseases and finding cures. Additionally, his background in chemistry provided him with the foundation needed to conduct innovative experiments. His perseverance in the face of adversity, both in his health and career, drove him to make significant contributions to science and public health.

Frequently Asked Questions:

1. How did Pasteur show the difference between pure and stale air?

Ans: Pasteur demonstrated the difference by conducting experiments with swan-neck flasks. He boiled broth in these flasks to sterilize it, then exposed one flask to the air, allowing microorganisms from the environment to enter. The other flask remained sealed, preventing air and contaminants from entering. Over time, the broth in the open flask became cloudy due to microbial growth, while the sealed flask remained clear. This experiment illustrated that stale air contained germs, while pure air did not, supporting his germ theory.

2. What was troubling French wine and silkworm industry Lille? How did Pasteur solve them?

Ans: French wine growers were troubled by a problem of wine spoilage caused by unwanted microorganisms that affected the fermentation process. Similarly, the silkworm industry was suffering from diseases that killed silkworms and disrupted silk production. Both industries faced significant losses due to these microbial issues. Pasteur solved the wine growers' problem by developing a process called pasteurization, which involved heating wine to kill harmful microorganisms without affecting its quality. For the silkworm industry, he identified the specific parasites causing the disease and introduced measures to improve silkworm rearing practices, ensuring healthier silkworm populations.

3.Explain the context "If you can cure animals, you can cure my son."

Ans: This statement reflects the desperation of a mother whose son was suffering from rabies. She approached Pasteur, who had successfully developed a rabies vaccine for animals. The mother's plea highlights the faith people had in Pasteur's work, believing that if he could save animals from the deadly disease, he could also save her son. It underscores the hope and trust placed in Pasteur's scientific abilities during a time when rabies was often fatal.

4.Explain the context "the future will belong to those who shall have done the most for humanity."

Ans: This statement emphasizes Pasteur's belief in the importance of contributing to the welfare of humanity through scientific research and discoveries. It conveys his conviction that true progress and recognition in the future will come to those who dedicate their lives to alleviating the suffering of others. This idea reflects Pasteur's commitment to using his scientific knowledge for the betterment of society and addressing public health challenges.

5.What is the difference between inoculation and vaccination?

Ans: Inoculation refers to the practice of introducing a pathogen (usually a less harmful form) into the body to stimulate an immune response. Vaccination, on the other hand, is a more specific term that involves using a vaccine, which contains weakened or killed microorganisms or their components, to prevent disease. Vaccination aims to provide immunity against specific infectious diseases without causing the illness itself.

6."Every research that Pasteur did was meant for the benefit of human beings," Justify.

Ans: This statement is justified by the numerous contributions Pasteur made to public health and medicine through his research. His work on the germ theory of disease, pasteurization, and vaccines for diseases like rabies and anthrax directly benefited humanity by preventing diseases, saving lives, and improving food safety. Pasteur's dedication to addressing public health issues reflects his commitment to using science for the betterment of society.

7.What were the two opposing laws that Pasteur spoke during inauguration of Pasteur Institute?

Ans: During the inauguration of the Pasteur Institute, Pasteur spoke about the laws of nature and the laws of humanity. He emphasized that while nature imposes challenges and diseases, it is humanity's responsibility to study, understand, and combat these challenges through scientific research and innovation. This highlights the ongoing battle between the forces of nature and the efforts of humans to improve health and well-being.

8.What is supreme happiness according to Pasteur?

Ans: According to Pasteur, supreme happiness lies in contributing to the welfare of humanity. He believed that true fulfillment comes from using one's knowledge and abilities to help others and alleviate suffering. This perspective reflects his own life's work and dedication to improving public health through scientific advancements.

9.What message did Pasteur give for young students on his 70th birthday?

Ans: On his 70th birthday, Pasteur encouraged young students to pursue knowledge and dedicate themselves to the service of humanity. He emphasized the importance of hard work, curiosity, and perseverance in the field of science. His message inspired students to strive for excellence in their studies and to use their education to make a positive impact on the world.

What Is Moral Action - Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi

A Note On The Author :

Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi (1869-1948), to the millions of Indians, Mahatma Gandhi, was the greatest of contemporary Indians and certainly one of the great men of all times. He was the mightiest force in the Indian political scene for nearly half a century and remained the profoundest influence on all areas of public life.

His method of non-violence and truth won freedom for India without blood shed and demonstrated to the modern man how love is more powerful than nuclear bombs. Proper to the man's ideals, Gandhiji's life and work are an open book. Gandhiji wrote and spoke tirelessly, using his characteristic charm and simplicity for which his autobiography to biography is the finest example.

What Is Moral Action Summary :

Gandhiji mentions six qualities of an action which qualify it to be called moral and the absence of which make it non-moral.

Many actions are done because they are a part of society's conventions. Without such behavior, there will be anarchy in society. Such acts are non-moral.

An act to be called moral should spring from our own will. It should not be performed mechanically, without any discrimination or thought.

A good act is not a moral act if the person does not have the intention to do good. Results of our action should be left to God. Alexander, though called Great, was not moral.

There should be no self-interest behind a moral act. Even honesty cannot be practiced as the best policy. It should be the only policy.

An act done for consideration of comfort and personal happiness in another world is non-moral. That action is moral which is done only for the sake of doing good. St. Francis Xavier and St. Theresa has devoted souls who prayed to God because they loved him.

Henry Clay and Daniel Webster lived virtuous lives but sacrificed their virtue just once, thereby negating all the good they had done.

Gandhiji concludes that judging the morality of a man's action is very difficult since we cannot penetrate the depths of his mind.

Short Answer Questions:

1.What does Gandhi say about conventional behavior?

Ans: Gandhi states that conventional behavior is often necessary for social order but does not equate to morality. Most actions are likely non-moral as they follow prevailing conventions without a deeper moral intention.

2.What distinguishes a moral act from a mechanical act?

Ans: A moral act must spring from one's own will and intention, while a mechanical act is performed without thought or understanding, akin to acting like a machine.

3.“The motive determines the quality of the act.”

Ans: Gandhi argues that the reason behind an action is essential in judging its morality, implying that actions done for pure reasons hold higher moral value.

4.What does Gandhi imply about actions done under compulsion?

Ans: Gandhi argues that actions done under compulsion lack moral value. True morality arises when actions are taken freely, without fear or external pressure.

5.What is the significance of the phrase “the God within us” in Gandhi’ s discourse?

Ans: This phrase emphasizes the idea that true moral action is guided by an inner conscience and self-awareness, reflecting a belief that morality stems from a higher moral authority within each individual.

Long Answer Questions:

1. Discuss the criteria Gandhi provides for moral action.

Ans: Gandhi outlines several criteria for moral action:▪ It must spring from one's own will, not be performed mechanically.▪ It should be done with good intentions.▪ The action must be free from fear compulsion.▪ It must not be motivated by self-interest or expectations of reward, whether in this life or the afterlife.▪ Ultimately, a moral action is performed solely for the sake of doing good.

2. Analyse Gandhi's view on the relationship between good actions and moral actions.

Ans: Gandhi posits that not all good actions are moral; the distinction lies in the intention behind the action. A good action performed for selfish reasons or personal gain cannot be classified as moral. For example, if an employer pays higher wages to avoid losing employees, that action is good in its effect but is not moral since it lacks altruism. Conversely, actions stemming from a sincere desire to help others, regardless of the outcome, qualify as moral.

3. What examples does Gandhi use to illustrate his points about morality?

Ans: Gandhi uses historical figures like Alexander the Great to illustrate that actions, although beneficial, can lack moral integrity. Alexander's conquests spread Greek culture but were driven by a desire for fame and conquest, thus undermining their moral value. He also mentions individuals like Henry Clay and Daniel Webster, who compromised their principles for ambition, demonstrating that even great deeds can be tainted by selfish motives.

4. Explain the implications of moral action according to Gandhi's philosophy.

Ans: According to Gandhi, moral action has far-reaching implications for individual character and societal values. He asserts that true morality is rooted in selflessness, genuine intention, and the willingness to act without fear or desire for reward. By promoting these ideals, individuals contribute to a just society and encourage moral behaviour in others, fostering an environment where ethical principles guide actions and decisions.

5. What does Gandhi believe is the essence of morality?

Ans: Gandhi believes that the essence of morality lies in the purity of intention behind actions. He emphasizes that morality should not be contingent upon external rewards or recognition but should emerge from a deep sense of duty and the desire to do good for its own sake. This intrinsic motivation is what separates moral actions from those driven by selfish desires or societal expectations.

Frequently Asked Questions:

1.What did St. Francis Xavier passionately pray for? Why?

Ans: St. Francis Xavier prayed passionately for the salvation of souls. He felt a deep responsibility to help others and believed that it was important to save as many souls as possible, reflecting his commitment to his faith and mission.

2.What did Mahatma Gandhi say about man's greed?

Ans: Mahatma Gandhi stated that man's greed knows no bounds and that it leads to the exploitation of others. He believed that greed is a major cause of social injustice and suffering in the world.

3.Why does Gandhi say that a moral act should be done without fear and compulsion?

Ans: Gandhi argued that a moral act should be done freely and willingly, without fear or coercion, because true morality arises from genuine intentions. When actions are performed under pressure or fear, they lack sincerity and do not reflect a true moral choice.

4.Explain the difference between a mechanical act and an intentional act with an example.

Ans: A mechanical act is performed without thought or intention, like a machine following commands. For example, if a person habitually says "thank you" without thinking, it's a mechanical act. An intentional act, however, is performed with awareness and purpose. For example, when someone helps a neighbour move because they genuinely care about their well-being, that is an intentional act.

5.What arguments does Gandhiji give to justify that a moral act should be free from fear and compulsion?

Ans: Gandhi argues that moral acts must arise from free will to be truly moral. When actions are taken under fear or compulsion, they do not reflect a person's true values or beliefs. He believes that morality should come from an inner sense of rightness and the desire to do good, rather than from external pressure.

6.What are the different principles that make an act a moral one, as told by M.K. Gandhi?

Ans: According to Gandhi, an act becomes moral when it arises from one's own will. It is performed with good intentions. It is done freely, without fear or compulsion. It aims to help others without expecting anything in return.

7.What did Mahatma Gandhi say about man's greed?

Ans: Gandhi emphasized that man's greed leads to destruction and suffering. He believed that unchecked greed results in exploitation and conflict, and it prevents individuals from acting morally and altruistically.

8.What is the argument that Gandhi Ji substantiates mentioning Saint Theresa?

Ans: Gandhi mentions Saint Theresa to illustrate that true service to humanity is rooted in selflessness. He uses her example to show that genuine acts of kindness should be motivated by love and compassion, rather than by a desire for recognition or reward.

9.Explain the context "God alone is the giver of fruit."

Ans: This phrase emphasizes that true success and rewards in life come from divine grace rather than human efforts alone. Gandhi suggests that people should focus on performing their duties sincerely without attachment to the results, as the ultimate outcomes are determined by a higher power.

10.Explain the context "Love born out of profit motive is no love."

Ans: This statement means that love that is motivated by selfish interests or the expectation of rewards is not true love. Gandhi believed that genuine love should be selfless, focusing on the well-being of others without seeking personal gain. True love is pure and arises from a deep sense of connection and compassion, not from a desire for benefits.

To a Pair of Sarus Cranes - Manmohan Singh

A Note On The Poet :

Manmohan Singh, an officer of the Indian Administrative Service, is a contemporary poet. His poems have been published in a number of magazines. This poem is chosen from his book titled Village Poems.

To a Pair of Sarus Cranes Poem Summary :

A hunter kills a male sarus crane for sport without realizing the impact it would have on the female sarus crane, he also does not realize what it can mean to the eco-system that they are a part of.

The female crane is distressed at the scene she witnesses, she gracefully flies around the scene in circles and croons over the disgraceful end of her partner.

The bird cries over the careless disregard and lack of dignity with which the dead bird is picked up by the callous hunters. She encircles the death scene making shrill cries over it.

The poet compares the shrill cries with the dots and pits of Morse code hinting at the keen ear required to understand the grief that is being expressed. The female crane then pecks at a few feathers of the male crane and in a desperate attempt to bring the male crane back to life tries to hatch the feathers to a toddling chick.

Finally, a wave that the female crane had never seen before comes and sweeps her away to death and closer to the dead male crane.

And the poet says that the female sarus crane went beyond Hume's words and beyond the legends and fables of human love.

Short Answer Questions:

1.What happens to the male Sarus Crane in the poem?

Ans: The male Sarus Crane is shot while trying to reach the sun, symbolizing his noble effort and tragic end.

2.How does the female crane react to the male crane's death?

Ans: The female crane flies in mourning, crying as she circles the sky. She expresses her grief over his death and returns to the scene to honour his memory.

3.What imagery is used to describe the male crane's body after it is shot?

Ans: The male crane is described as lying like "dirty linen in a coarse washing bag," which emphasizes the humiliation and disgrace of his death.

4.What does the female crane do with the feathers of the male crane?

Ans: The female crane kisses a few feathers and picks the ones that the wind has not taken away, symbolizing her deep connection and grief for her mate.

5.What does the line "a wave of the seas she had never seen came to her from far away" suggest?

Ans: This line suggests an overwhelming force of emotion or fate that carries her beyond her current experience, indicating a profound sense of loss and longing.

Long Answer Questions:

1.Discuss the significance of the male crane's attempt to "pull the reluctant sun."

Ans: The male crane's attempt to "pull the reluctant sun" symbolizes his struggle against adversity and his noble aspirations. This action can be interpreted as a metaphor for striving for hope and light, showcasing the crane's determination and connection to the natural world. It also highlights the tragic nature of his death, as he is shot while engaging in such a meaningful and beautiful act.

2.How does the poet convey the intensity of the female crane's grief?

Ans: The poet conveys the female crane's grief through vivid imagery and metaphors, such as the "Morse code of bird's sorrow," which represents her mourning as a series of emotional signals transmitted to the air. The description of her actions kissing the feathers and returning to the scene highlights her profound sadness and the depth of her love for her mate, emphasizing the emotional weight of her loss.

3. Analyse the use of personification in the poem.

Ans: The poem employs personification to give human-like qualities to the cranes, particularly in how they express emotions such as love and grief. By describing the cranes' actions and feelings in a relatable way, the poet allows readers to empathize with their plight, transforming the cranes into symbols of fidelity and loss. This personification enhances the emotional impact of the poem, drawing attention to the moral implications of human actions toward nature.

4. What is the overall message of the poem regarding human interaction with nature?

Ans: The overall message of the poem suggests that human actions can have devastating consequences on nature and its creatures. The tragic death of the male crane serves as a critique of humanity's disregard for the natural world, highlighting the moral responsibility to protect and respect all living beings. The poem calls for reflection on how actions affect not only individual animals but also the broader ecosystem, urging a deeper understanding of the interconnectedness of life.

5. How does the poem reflect on themes of love and loss?

Ans: The poem intricately weaves themes of love and loss through the portrayal of the crane couple. Their bond represents a deep, enduring love that transcends their tragic circumstances. The female crane's grief and her nurturing actions reflect the pain of losing a loved one, emphasizing the emotional toll of such loss. Through the lens of nature, the poem evokes universal feelings of love, mourning, and the profound impact that loss can have on individuals, regardless of species.

Abraham Lincoln's Letter - Abraham Lincoln

A Note The Poet :

Abraham Lincoln (1809-1865) was the sixteenth President of the United States of America, Born to parents who struggled to make a living in Kentucky, Lincoln made great efforts to acquire knowledge. An outspoken opponent of the system of slavery, Lincoln defeated the confederacy in the American Civil War and introduced the measures the abolished slavery

Abraham Lincoln's Letter Poem Summary :

In this letter, Abraham Lincoln believed to have written to his son's teacher, he emphasizes on the values that he would like his son to learn. He wants his son to learn that all men are not just but he also wants his teacher to teach him that for every bad person there is a good person available in the world.

He further wants his son's teacher to teach him the value of labour and hard work and he wants his son to learn that a dollar earned is of higher value than 5 dollars found without hard work.

He wants him to be away from jealousy and also learn the secret of quiet laughter. He wants his son to be taught that bullies are the easiest to please by saying yes to all their demands.

He wants his son to be taught the wonder of books. He wants also that his son is taught the value of quiet time in which he can ponder over the mysteries of nature and also learn that it is far more honourable to fail than to cheat.

He wants his son to be taught to have faith in his own ideas and to be gentle with the gentle and tough with the tough.

He wants the teacher to give his son the strength not to follow the crowd and filter all that he hears with the filter of truth. He wants the teacher to teach his son that one can laugh when one is sad yet that there is no shame in tears.

He wants his son to be taught how to be wary of too much sweetness and keep cynical, negative people away. He further asks the teacher to teach his son to sell his skills and talents to the highest bidder but also ensure that he never trades his soul for a price tag.

He wants his son to be taught to fight for what he thinks is right and he brave and to have faith in himself and others. He ends the letter with a gentle order that the above things be taught to his son who is, after all, such a fine boy.

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Short Answer Questions:

1.What does Lincoln want his son to learn about people?

Ans: Lincoln wants his son to learn that not all people are just or truthful, but for every bad person, there is also a good one. He wants him to understand that for every selfish politician, there is a dedicated leader, and for every enemy, there is a friend.

2.Why does Lincoln emphasize the value of a dollar earned over five found?

Ans: Lincoln believes that earning a dollar through hard work is more valuable than finding five dollars, as the experience of earning teaches effort, responsibility, and the satisfaction that comes from honest labour.

3.What advice does Lincoln give about handling bullies?

Ans: Lincoln advises that bullies are often the easiest to defeat, suggesting that his son should face them with courage and not be intimidated by them.

4.What is the significance of “quiet laughter” in Lincoln’s letter?

Ans: Lincoln suggests that his son should learn to appreciate the simple, quiet joys of life, and not be consumed by envy. Quiet laughter represents contentment and the ability to find peace and happiness in everyday moments.

5.What does Lincoln want his son to learn about faith in his own ideas?

Ans: Lincoln wants his son to have confidence in his own thoughts and ideas, even if others disagree. He believes it’s important for his son to trust his own judgment and stand firm in his beliefs.

Long Answer Questions:

1.Discuss the balance Lincoln seeks between academic learning and learning from nature.

Ans: Lincoln emphasizes the importance of both academic knowledge and learning from nature. He wants his son to be taught the value of books, but also to have time to appreciate the wonders of the natural world the birds, bees, and flowers. This balance helps cultivate a well-rounded individual who is intellectually sharp and spiritually connected to nature. It reflects Lincoln’s belief that education should develop both the mind and the soul.

2.How does Lincoln suggest his son should handle failure and success?

Ans: Lincoln wants his son to understand that both failure and success are part of life’s journey. He believes it is more honourable to fail than to cheat, suggesting that integrity is more important than winning. He also wants his son to enjoy success when it comes but not to be overly affected by failure, as both are valuable learning experiences.

3. Analyse Lincoln's views on conformity and independence in the letter.

Ans: Lincoln advises his son not to follow the crowd blindly, even when everyone else is joining in. He encourages independent thought, urging his son to listen to all but to filter what he hears through the "screen of truth." Lincoln values self-reliance and critical thinking, advocating for standing firm in one's beliefs, even when faced with pressure to conform.

4. What does Lincoln mean by "Teach him to sell his brawn and brain to the highest bidders, but never to put a price tag on his soul"?

Ans: This line emphasizes the importance of valuing one's skills and talents but not compromising one's morals. Lincoln wants his son to use his physical and intellectual abilities to earn a good living, but he warns against sacrificing integrity for money. The "soul" represents one's character and conscience, which should never be sold for any material gain.

5. How does Lincoln describe the qualities of courage and patience in the letter?

Ans: Lincoln describes courage and patience as complementary traits. He wants his son to have the courage to act when necessary and not to follow the crowd. At the same time, he encourages patience, recognizing that bravery also involves waiting for the right moment to act. Lincoln believes that true courage is not just about bold action but also about having the patience to endure challenges and make wise decisions.

Vachana - Basavanna

A Note On The Poet :

BASAVANNA (11/06/1167 to 1168) was a great social reformer, who strove to build a new social order, free from caste, class and orthodoxy. He was the leader of the medieval religious movement, Veerasaivism of which the Kannada Vachanas are the most important texts. If one were to choose a single poem to represent the whole extraordinary body of religious lyrics called the Vachanas, one cannot do better than choose the above poem of Basavanna. It dramatizes several of the themes and oppositions characteristic of the movement called Veerasaivism. Akkamahadevi, Allama Prabhu, Devara Dasimayya are some of the other great Veerashaiva poets.

Vachana Poem Summary :

The poet desires to please God by building a temple for him but is a poor man, and hence cannot do so.

He wonders in anguish whether he will ever be able to please God.

He decides to treat his own body as a temple, with his legs for pillars, body for the shrine and the head for a cupola of gold.

He consoles himself saying that 'things standing shall fall', meaning that buildings will be destroyed by wind, rain and sunshine.

He is happy that 'the moving ever shall stay', meaning that he will be able to carry the 'temple' and his 'God' forever with himself, and so it will never be destroyed. It shall 'stay'.

The poem or vachana was written by Basavanna at a time when people other than high caste people or Brahmins could not enter temples.

Short Answer Questions:

1.What do rich people build to show their devotion, according to Basavanna?

Ans: Rich people build grand temples for Lord Shiva to show their devotion.

2.What does the speaker offer to God instead of building a temple?

Ans: The speaker offers his own body as a temple for God, where his legs are the pillars, the body is the shrine, and the head is the cupola of gold.

3.What is meant by "the head a cupola of gold"?

Ans: This means that the speaker's head represents the dome of the temple, symbolizing the crown or highest point of the temple, showing the sacredness of the human body.

4.Who is addressed as "the lord of the meeting rivers"?

Ans: Lord Shiva is addressed as the "lord of the meeting rivers."

5.What will eventually happen to things that stand still, according to the vachana?

Ans: According to the vachana, things that stand still (like temples) will eventually fall or decay.

Long Answer Questions:

1.Explain how Basavanna contrasts the devotion of rich people with his own form of devotion.

Ans: Basavanna contrasts the devotion of rich people, who build temples made of stone and wealth, with his own form of inner devotion. Being poor, he cannot build physical temples, but he offers his own body as a temple for God. His legs are the pillars, the body is the shrine, and the head is the dome. This metaphor shows that real devotion comes from within, and the act of living a righteous life is more meaningful than building grand monuments. The physical temples will eventually decay, but inner devotion, symbolized by movement or action, will last forever.

2.What does Basavanna mean by "things standing shall fall, but the moving ever shall stay"?

Ans: In this line, Basavanna highlights the temporary nature of physical structures and the eternal nature of inner devotion and action. "Things standing" refers to structures like temples, which are stationary and will eventually fall into ruin. In contrast, "the moving" refers to actions, spiritual progress, and devotion that come from within, which will remain timeless. Basavanna suggests that while material things are temporary, the spiritual journey and moral actions are eternal and indestructible.

Lochinvar - Walter Scott

A Note On The Poet :

Sir Walter Scott (1771-1832) was an excellent storyteller, both in prose and in verse. In this popular ballad, he tells us how in olden days, brave young men in Scotland possessed the necessary dash and pluck to do extraordinary things. His narrative poems fascinate the reader by their gripping action, stirring measure and imaginative appeal.

Lochinvar Poem Summary :

This ballad is about a young promising knight of the highlands.

He came riding through the wide border of the west, on his horse which was one of the best horses. For defense, he had only a sword.

He rode all alone to meet the girl he loved. Lochinvar was well-known for his bravery both in war and love.

He did not stop for even a second, no matter what difficulties came in his path.

He even swam across the Esk river where there was no shallow point (ford). However, even before he reached Nether by Hall the bride had consented to marry someone else, a man who was both cowardly and laggard in love.

Bravely, Lochinvar entered the Nether by Hall, even though it was filled with the bride's relatives and brothers.

The bride's father asked him if he had entered in peace or to fight.

Lochinvar replied that for a long time he had wooed his daughter, but his marriage proposal had been rejected. His love for her was like the waters of the Solway, had been high like the swollen water but now had ebbed.

He had come to dance one last time with Ellen and drink one cup of wine at her wedding.

He also added that there were more beautiful girls in Scotland who would readily become his wife.

The bride Ellen gave him a goblet of wine, which, he drank and then they danced.

She had a smile on her lips, but there were tears in her eyes. While dancing, Lochinvar whispered something in her ear.

They danced towards the door where his horse was waiting. Quickly he swung her on the saddle and rode away.

All the clans of the bride's side chased them but could not catch them, and so they escaped.

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Short Answer Questions:

1.How was Lochinvar greeted by the bride's father when he entered the Netherby Hall?

Ans: The bride's father greeted Lochinvar with suspicion, asking if he had come in peace or war, or if he had come to dance at the wedding. The father had his hand on his sword, showing he was ready to defend his daughter, but he did not suspect Lochinvar's true intentions.

2.Why didn't Ellen's father suspect Lochinvar's intentions?

Ans: Ellen's father didn't suspect Lochinvar's intentions because Lochinvar claimed that he only wanted to drink a cup of wine and dance one last time with Ellen. His calm demeanor and the appearance of peace misled the father into believing Lochinvar was not there to cause trouble.

3.What did the bride's father ask Lochinvar?

Ans: The bride's father asked Lochinvar whether he had come in peace, for war, or to dance at the wedding. This showed the father was cautious but unaware of Lochinvar's plan to take Ellen away.

4.How did Lochinvar finally win Ellen for himself?

Ans: Lochinvar won Ellen by boldly dancing with her at the wedding and then swiftly carrying her off on his horse before anyone could react. He escaped with Ellen on his steed, outpacing their pursuers, securing her love and escaping with her from Netherby Hall.

5.Was Ellen expecting Lochinvar? How does the poet describe this thought?

Ans: Ellen was not openly expecting Lochinvar, but her reactions blushing, sighing, and showing both a smile and a tear suggest that she still had feelings for him. Her mixed emotions hint that she might have hoped for his arrival, even though her marriage to another man had already been arranged.

6.What did the bride's father ask Lochinvar?

Ans: The bride's father asked Lochinvar if he had come in peace, for war, or to dance at the wedding. This question reflects the father's uncertainty about Lochinvar's intentions, though he was unaware that Lochinvar planned to take his daughter away.

Long Answer Questions:

1. "Only the brave deserve the fair." Justify the statement with reference to the poem.

Ans: In the poem, Lochinvar exemplifies bravery by riding alone, unarmed, and boldly entering the wedding hall to claim Ellen. His courage in facing the bride's family, his daring act of leading Ellen in a dance, and his swift escape with her on horseback show that it is his bravery that wins Ellen's heart. The poem suggests that only those who are bold and courageous, like Lochinvar, deserve to win the love of someone as beautiful and fair as Ellen. His bravery and decisiveness set him apart from the cowardly bridegroom, who stands silently, incapable of asserting himself.

2. Explain the context "Love swells like a Solway but ebbs like a tide."

Ans: This line reflects Lochinvar's feelings for Ellen. He says that his love, once denied by her father, grew stronger, much like the Solway Firth, whose waters swell. However, he acknowledges that love, like the tide, can also ebb or diminish over time. Here, Lochinvar implies that while his love for Ellen had been powerful, it might be too late now that she is about to marry someone else. He uses this imagery to justify his return to claim her one last time, even though their love had been interrupted.

3. Explain the context "I long woo'd your daughter, my suit you denied."

Ans: Lochinvar speaks this line to Ellen's father, reminding him that he had previously courted Ellen but was rejected. He uses this as part of his explanation for arriving at the wedding. Although his proposal was denied, Lochinvar shows that his feelings for Ellen remain strong, and this statement sets the stage for his bold act of reclaiming her during the wedding.

4. Sketch the character of Lochinvar.

Ans: Lochinvar is depicted as a brave, bold, and romantic hero. He is fearless in both love and war, as shown by his daring journey to Netherby Hall to claim Ellen. His courage is matched by his charm and determination. He is confident, undeterred by obstacles, and possesses a strong sense of loyalty and love. Lochinvar's decisive actions, including his escape with Ellen, reveal his resourcefulness and heroism.

A Poison Tree - William Blake

A Note On The Poet :

William Blake (1757-1827) belonged to the pre-Romantic period in English Literature. Although he did not have formal schooling, he became a mystic poet by his ability to see the world of God behind the physical world.

A Poison Tree Poem Summary :

The poet says that he was angry with his friend but he explained the reason of his anger and so he was satisfied and continued his friendship. He was also angry with his enemy but he did not tell him as much. His anger against his enemy increased day by day.

He allowed the enmity to grow with fear. He shed tears day and night for not being able to express his feelings to his enemy. He appeared to be happy in the external world and he used to smile to cover his anger.

The tree of enmity began to grow as he nourished it day and night with fears and tears. It bore a fruit which the enemy saw with eager eyes. Knowing that it was my fruit, he stole one night into my garden.

In the morning I was happy to see – my enemy lying dead under the tree. Because it was a Poison Tree.

Short Answer Questions:

1.How did the speaker resolve his anger with his friend?

Ans: The speaker resolved his anger with his friend by expressing it, which caused the anger to disappear.

2.What happens when the speaker suppresses his anger toward his enemy?

Ans: When the speaker suppresses his anger, it grows stronger, eventually leading to the creation of a poisonous apple that leads to his enemy's downfall.

3.What does the apple symbolize in the poem?

Ans: The apple symbolizes the speaker's growing anger and hatred, which becomes a tool of destruction for his enemy.

4.How does the speaker nurture his anger?

Ans: The speaker nurtures his anger with fears, tears, deceitful smiles, and hidden emotions, allowing it to grow.

5.“In the morning glad I see / My foe outstretched beneath the tree.”

Ans: This concluding line reveals the deadly consequences of suppressed anger, warning that hatred and vengeance ultimately cause suffering.

Long Answer Questions:

1.How does Blake use the metaphor of a tree to illustrate the dangers of suppressed anger?

Ans: Blake uses the tree as a metaphor for suppressed anger, showing how it grows when not expressed. Just as a tree needs water and sunlight to grow, the speaker “waters” his anger with fears and tears and “suns” it with deceitful smiles. The tree produces a bright, tempting apple, symbolizing the destructive power of unresolved emotions. This metaphor highlights the dangers of internalized anger, suggesting that, when left unchecked, it can lead to harm and destruction.

2.Discuss the contrast between the speaker's anger toward his friend and his anger toward his foe.

Ans: The speaker handles his anger toward his friend by expressing it openly, which leads to resolution and the end of the anger. In contrast, his anger toward his foe is kept hidden and unspoken, allowing it to fester and grow. This contrast illustrates the different outcomes of expressed versus suppressed anger while sharing anger with a friend can lead to reconciliation, hiding it from an enemy can lead to revenge and harm.

3.Explain the symbolism of the apple in the poem.

Ans: The apple in the poem symbolizes the speaker's suppressed anger and the eventual harm it causes. The apple grows from the speaker's anger and becomes a tool of temptation and destruction, much like the forbidden fruit in the Bible's Garden of Eden. It is bright and attractive, luring the foe to steal and consume it. However, it is also poisonous, representing how suppressed emotions can become dangerous. The apple's allure and deadly outcome underscore the theme that unresolved anger can lead to destructive consequences.

4.How does the poem reflect on the theme of revenge?

Ans: The poem reflects on the theme of revenge by showing how suppressed anger turns into a desire for retaliation. The speaker does not confront his foe directly but instead allows his anger to grow in secret. The apple, born from this anger, becomes a weapon of revenge. The foe is tempted by the apple and ultimately falls victim to the speaker's unexpressed wrath. The poem suggests that revenge, while satisfying in the moment, stems from unresolved negative emotions and results in harm for both the victim and the one seeking vengeance.

5.What is the moral message of the poem A Poison Tree?

Ans: The moral message of the poem is that harbouring anger and resentment without addressing it can lead to destructive consequences. Blake contrasts the outcomes of expressed and suppressed anger, showing that while open communication can lead to reconciliation, keeping anger inside allows it to grow and fester. The poem suggests that dealing with emotions in a healthy way is important, as unresolved anger can ultimately harm both the person who harbours it and others around them.

Treasure Island - R.L. Stevenson

A Note On the Writer :

Robert Louis Stevenson was a Scottish novelist, essayist, poet and travel writer. He is best known for the novels *Treasure Island*, *Strange Case of Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde*, and *Kidnapped*, and the poetry collection *A Child's Garden of Verses*.

Treasure Island Summary :

This story unfolds in a seaside inn named Admiral Benbow owned by Jim Hawkins family.

One day an old seaman named Billy arrives at the inn and takes a room there. His cherished possession was an old sea- chest.

Several weeks after his arrive an evil looking sailor comes to the inn. Billy has a fight with him which results in the evil man being wounded. He runs away, and Billy falls exhausted on the floor. He suffers a fatal seizure.

Jim and his mother go through his cherished chest and discover a treasure map. Jim's mother took only that much money as Billy owed. Jim shows it to Squire Trelawney and Doctor Livesey.

They plan a voyage to the island where the treasure is hidden. The squire travels to Bristol where he purchased a ship named *The Hispaniola*. He hires a sea-captain and staffs it with sailors recommended by the one-legged cook – Long John Silver.

When they sail towards the treasure island Jim inadvertently overhears a conversation among, Silver and some of the crew members.

They were planning a mutiny. They had also been on the ship that had carried the treasure that Jim and his friends were seeking.

Jim relates all he has heard to his friends. When they reach the island, fighting breaks out among the two groups.

Jim hides on the island and over their meets – Ben Gunn, another ex-crew member, who had been marooned on that island three years back.

They become friends as Ben Gunn agree to help Jim. In the meantime, Trelawney and Livesey along with the loyal crew members row ashore. They find a stockade which they take for themselves.

Long John Silver tries to negotiate with them but to no avail. Jim steals of to the ship and cuts the ropes, setting it adrift.

When he returns to the stockade he finds that his friends have given the map to the pirates. The next day, when the pirates go to the spot where the treasure is hidden, they find that it is gone.

This angers the pirates and they attacked Silver and Jim, but the Squire and doctor save them.

They then go to Gunn's cave to recover the hidden treasure. Silver surrenders to them.

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Short Answer Questions:

1.What did Jim Hawkins discover in the chest of the old pirate?

Ans: Jim finds a treasure map in the chest of the pirate Billy Bones. This map leads to a hidden treasure, setting the stage for the entire adventure.

2.Who commands the ship Hispaniola?

Ans: Captain Smollett is the commander of the Hispaniola. He is a strict and experienced captain who doesn't trust the crew, which later turns out to be the right instinct.

3.Who is the one-legged pirate in the story?

Ans: Long John Silver, the ship's cook, is the one-legged pirate. Though he pretends to be friendly at first, he is actually the leader of the mutineers.

4.What quality helps Jim survive the challenges he faces?

Ans: Jim's quick thinking, courage, and resourcefulness help him survive. He often makes smart decisions in the face of danger, such as when he escapes from the pirates.

5.What is the name of the ship in Treasure Island?

Ans: The Hispaniola is the ship that Jim and the crew sail on in search of the treasure. It plays a central role in the journey.

Long Answer Questions:

1.Describe Jim Hawkins' discovery and how it leads to his adventure.

Ans: When Jim Hawkins discovers the treasure map in the chest of the pirate Billy Bones, it leads him and several others on a dangerous voyage across the sea. The map shows the location of a hidden treasure on an island, which becomes the focus of their adventure. The discovery sparks excitement but also brings danger, as they soon realize that many people, including pirates, are also after the treasure.

2.How does Long John Silver initially present himself, and what is later revealed about his character?

Ans: Long John Silver presents himself as a kind and trustworthy cook on the ship, which makes others believe he is harmless. However, as the story unfolds, it is revealed that he is actually the leader of a group of pirates who intend to steal the treasure. His ability to manipulate people by hiding his true nature makes him one of the most dangerous characters in the story.

3.Discuss the role of Captain Smollett in the journey to find the treasure.

Ans: Captain Smollett is the no-nonsense captain of the Hispaniola. He is cautious and doesn't trust the crew, especially when he senses there might be trouble. His leadership is crucial, as he helps organize the loyal members of the crew to defend themselves against the pirates. Smollett's role highlights the importance of experience and judgment during their dangerous mission.

4.What challenges does Jim face on the island, and how does he handle them?

Ans: On the island, Jim faces multiple threats such as hostile pirates, the treacherous terrain, and the constant need to survive. At one point, he takes control of the Hispaniola by himself, showing great bravery. He also encounters Ben Gunn, a marooned pirate, who helps him in critical moments. Jim handles these challenges by staying calm and thinking through his options, often making brave decisions that help his group.

5.Explain how Jim Hawkins' quick thinking aids him throughout the adventure.

Ans: Jim Hawkins consistently demonstrates quick thinking, such as when he overhears the pirates' plan to mutiny and warns the others. Another instance is when he sneaks aboard the Hispaniola to cut the ship loose, saving them from being stranded. Jim's ability to act swiftly and wisely in dangerous situations allows him to stay one step ahead of the pirates.

Karna – C. Rajagopalachari

A Note On the Writer :

Chakravarti Rajagopalachari, popularly known as Rajaji or C.R., also known as Mootharignar Rajaji, was an Indian statesman, writer, lawyer, and Indian independence activist. Rajagopalachari was the last Governor-General of India, as, when India became a republic in 1950, the office was abolished.

Karna Summary :

The Pandavas and the Kauravas learnt the practice of arms both from Kripacharya and Dronacharya.

A day was fixed for the test and the public was also invited to witness it. Arjuna showed his skills with weapons and Duryodhana got jealousy of him.

At the close of the day, a youth entered and challenged Arjuna. Kripacharya, who knew the rules of single combat, told Karna that only a high-born prince can fight him.

On hearing this, Karna bent down his head but Duryodhana immediately crowned him as the King of Anga.

The combat was interrupted by the entry of Adhiratha, Karna's foster father and Duryodhana drove away Karna in his chariot.

Indra, on the other hand, realised the gravity of the situation and put on the garb of a Brahman to ask Karna for his earrings and armour in charity. Despite Sun God's warning to Karna, he cut off both the things and gave them to the Brahmana.

Indra became happy and bade Karna to ask for any boon he wanted. Karna asked for the weapon (Sakti) which had the power to kill enemies and his wish was granted. Karna became the disciple of Parasuram. He learnt from him the mantra for using Brahmastra.

Once Karna told a lie to his guru that he was a Brahmana. When the truth came out, Parasuram got angry and cursed him saying that the Brahmastra would fail him at a crucial moment.

Before going for the battle Karna went to Bhishma for his blessings and he got it from him. Then started the great battle with Karna fighting from Duryodhana's side. At one moment, the wheel of his chariot sunk five fingers deep in the mud.

Arjuna aimed at him and Karna was reminded of Parasurama's curse. Krishna also reminded him of all his bad deeds which he had done in the company of Duryodhana. Karna bent his head in shame but again tried to take out the wheel from the mind.

Arjuna's mind was wavering but Krishna told him to sever the head of Karna which he did. Thus, ended the life-story of a brave warrior.

Frequently Asked Questions :

1.What made Kripacharya object to Karna joining in the battle?

Ans: Kripacharya objected because he believed that only royal-born warriors could challenge the princes like Arjuna. Karna's lineage was unknown at the time, and Kripacharya argued that without knowing his birth, it was improper for Karna to compete with a prince.

2.What was the curse pronounced by Parasurama?

Ans: Parasurama, who hated Kshatriyas, taught Karna because Karna lied and said he was a Brahmin. When Parasurama discovered Karna's true identity as a Kshatriya, he cursed Karna. He declared that Karna would forget the mantras for his divine weapons when he needed them most, which would lead to his defeat in battle.

3.What was the condition laid by Indra while granting the boon to Karna?

Ans: Indra, disguised as a Brahmana, asked Karna for his protective armour (kavacha) and earrings (kundalas). In return for Karna's generosity, Indra gave him a powerful weapon called the Shakti. However, the condition was that Karna could use the Shakti only once, and after that, it would return to Indra, leaving Karna defenceless against powerful enemies.

4.Why was Arjuna's mind wavering when Lord Krishna asked him to slay Karna?

Ans: Arjuna hesitated because Karna's chariot was stuck in the mud, and Karna was trying to lift the wheel out. It seemed unfair to Arjuna to attack an enemy who was defenseless at that moment. Despite this, Krishna reminded Arjuna of Karna's past wrongs and urged him to act.

5.How did Duryodhana restore Karna's honour?

Ans: Duryodhana restored Karna's honour by making him the king of Anga. This was a strategic move, as it gave Karna the status of a royal, which allowed him to participate in battles alongside the Kauravas, and it also cemented Karna's loyalty to Duryodhana.

6.How did Parashurama realise that Karna was not a Brahmana?

Ans: Parashurama realized that Karna was not a Brahmana when a bee stung Karna while he was resting on Karna's lap. Karna bore the pain silently without disturbing Parashurama. When Parashurama awoke and saw the blood, he knew that only a Kshatriya could endure such pain without flinching, as a Brahmana would not have that level of endurance.

7.What mishap happened to Karna's chariot?

Ans: During the fierce battle between Karna and Arjuna, Karna's chariot wheel sank into the soft mud. This was a critical mishap because it left Karna vulnerable. He dismounted to free the wheel, but this distraction made him an easy target for Arjuna.

8.What does Bhishma ask Karna to do?

Ans: Bhishma, who had great respect for the Pandavas, asked Karna not to participate in the war as long as Bhishma was the commander of the Kaurava army. Bhishma disapproved of Karna's treatment of the Pandavas and was not fond of Karna's rivalry with Arjuna. Bhishma believed Karna's presence would bring unnecessary conflict within their ranks.

9.Describe how and why did Indra approach Karna.

Ans: Indra, the father of Arjuna, approached Karna in disguise as a Brahmana. He knew that Karna was invincible as long as he had his natural armour and earrings, which were gifts from the sun god. Indra asked Karna for these items, knowing Karna would give them up due to his extreme generosity. Indra did this to protect Arjuna, as Karna was his strongest rival.

10.Karna is easily one of the most tragic and compelling characters of the epic. List any five great qualities of Karna which you admire most and justify your choice of qualities.

Ans: **Generosity:** Karna was renowned for his charitable nature. He gave away his armour and earrings to Indra, even though they were his natural protection. This selflessness, even at the cost of his own life, shows his noble heart.

Loyalty: Karna remained faithful to Duryodhana, despite knowing that Duryodhana's cause was unjust. He valued loyalty and friendship more than personal gain, making him a true ally.

Courage: Throughout his life, Karna faced many challenges. He was insulted for his unknown lineage, yet he never gave up and became one of the greatest warriors of his time.

Humility: Although he possessed great power and skill, Karna did not boast about his abilities. He remained humble, even when he was made king of Anga.

Integrity: Karna always kept his word. For example, he promised his teacher Drona that he would not fight while Bhishma led the army, and he honoured this vow despite his eagerness to battle Arjuna.